

Economic Democracy

History, Power & Participation — a framework for engaging the structural questions our generation must answer.

01 · THE QUESTION BEHIND THE COURSE

America is an experiment.

Two and a half centuries of one endless argument about who holds power, who benefits, and what we owe one another. That argument has never been settled, and our generation is now inheriting its hardest version. How do we sustain Social Security in an aging society? How do we deliver health care without bankrupting families? How do we build ownership and wealth in an economy increasingly driven by AI and automation? This is the 250th year of that experiment, and the questions are sharper than they have been in living memory.

Most students leave high school unprepared to participate in these conversations. They learn the mechanics of government but almost nothing about how the economy actually shapes their lives. Economic Democracy offers a different lens — a framework for recognizing the patterns that run through American history, and for using political economy as a tool for dialogue and problem-solving rather than as ammunition for winning arguments about the past.

02 · THE FRAMEWORK

The Power, Democracy & Economy Matrix

The course refuses the single left-right axis that organizes most political and economic discussion. In its place, a two-axis framework asks two independent questions: where does economic power sit, and to whom is that power accountable?

TWO AXES · FOUR QUADRANTS

X — Power Location: *private* ↔ *public*

Y — Accountability: *elite / expert* ↔ *democratic / popular*

All four quadrants hold genuine tension. None is declared correct. Students place every figure they study — from Hamilton to Andreessen — on the matrix, and then defend their own placement. The framework teaches interpretation, not sorting; it builds democratic habits of mind.

04 · THE PEOPLE BEHIND THE WORK

BUILT BY

Alfredo Mathew III

Twenty-five years building civic education through the classroom and the economic ecosystem. Founding teacher at Mott Haven Village Prep in the South Bronx and Teacher of the Year for the Bronx High Schools in 2002–03. AP and IB History teacher at Blair High School in Pasadena, and U.S. History teacher in Oakland public schools. Bay Area Director of the Network for Teaching Entrepreneurship, connecting thousands of high school students annually to the Silicon Valley innovation economy. Co-founder of ESO Ventures, which closed \$24M in capital and incubated 700+ businesses owned by founders historically left out of wealth-building. TEDx speaker (top 10 globally, May 2025, 100,000+ views). Author of *Redefining the American Dream* and founder of SPCC.1.

FACILITATION BY

Amy Chan

Twenty-five years developing civic education and youth leadership programs. High school English teacher in Japan, middle school literacy teacher with KIPP in Oakland, and ran summer and after-school programs with Citizen Schools in Boston and the Coro Center for Civic Leadership in San Francisco. As Associate Dean and Director of the University Community Service Center — founded by Michelle Obama at the University of Chicago — oversaw 13 programs engaging over 3,000 students annually. Holds a master's in education and a certificate in civics education and youth participatory politics, both from Harvard. Principal at SPCC.1 and lead facilitator for the curriculum's monthly cohort sessions.

03 · WHAT IS BUILT

The curriculum, today.

— **Two-year scope & sequence** — ten units across U.S. History, Government, Economics, and CTE.

— **The Concept Library** — 36 economic concept primers across five clusters, each taught as judgment rather than memorization.

— **The 250 Voices Anthology** — one significant American thinker, builder, or actor per year, 1776–2026, each placed on the matrix.

— **Model projects** — the Civic Economy Role-Play Lab and the Define & Defend capstone, AI-proof by design.

— **The Teaching Toolkit** — a unit-design guide, warm-up and exit-ticket routines, and rubrics built to grade reasoning, not agreement.

— **Student & adoption materials** — a student handbook and a standards crosswalk to the 2025 CEE pillars and the C3 framework.

— **A live curriculum site** — at economicdemocracy.co — educator portal, framework rationale, and free teacher guides.

— **Monthly cohort sessions** — four to five live sessions per semester, 15–18 educators per cohort, facilitated by Alfredo and Amy.

Three ways in, one community.

The curriculum is the content. The cohort is the learning experience. The relationships are the outcome.

Economic Democracy is delivered as one learning community with multiple entry points. Gain access to the curriculum and monthly cohort sessions as an individual teacher, a school, or a network. What changes across the three tiers is the depth of the relationship.

TIER 01 · INDIVIDUAL EDUCATOR

Educator Pilot

A single teacher, any subject, any school. The easiest way to enter the work.

Full access to the curriculum and a seat in the monthly cohort with Alfredo, Amy, and 15–18 other teachers from across the country. The community is the experience — teachers come for the curriculum and stay for the relationships they build with peers wrestling with the same questions.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Full curriculum site access — units, scope and sequence, model projects, assessment rubrics
- The 250 Voices Anthology — one significant American thinker, builder, or actor per year, 1776–2026
- Seat in the monthly cohort — four to five live sessions per semester, 15–18 educators per cohort
- Direct facilitation by Alfredo and Amy in every session
- Per-semester enrollment — teachers can re-enroll each term to remain in the community

INVESTMENT

\$500

per teacher
· per semester

TIER 02 · SCHOOL-LEVEL PARTNERSHIP

School Adoption

A school running the curriculum across multiple classrooms and sections, full academic year.

Everything in the Educator Pilot, scaled across the school — and a partnership between the curriculum team and the school's teaching faculty across the academic year. The cohort calls remain shared with educators from other schools; what's added at this tier is the private relationship at the school level.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- Site license — up to 5 teachers and unlimited students at the school
- Teaching faculty join the same monthly cohort sessions with educators from across the country
- Monthly check-ins with the school's teaching team across the year
- Customized support aligned to the school's academic calendar
- Year-end evaluation report for school administration

INVESTMENT

\$5,000

per school
· per year

TIER 03 · NETWORK-LEVEL PARTNERSHIP

Network Partnership

A district, charter network, diocesan school system, or institutional network.

Everything in School Adoption, scaled across the network — and a cohort the network owns. Alfredo and Amy facilitate a dedicated cohort attended only by the network's educators, grounded in the network's specific context. The network shapes the curriculum's evolution as it grows.

WHAT'S INCLUDED

- The network's own dedicated cohort — Alfredo and/or Amy as facilitators
- Train-the-trainer infrastructure for the network's own PD staff to carry the work forward
- Ongoing curriculum development partnership — the network shapes the 250 Voices anthology
- Custom PD modules and specific content scoped à la carte, priced separately
- Direct facilitation access to Alfredo and/or Amy

INVESTMENT

\$25,000

per network
· per year

Workplace adaptation. The framework is also being adapted for employee-owned companies and worker cooperatives; workplace engagements are scoped individually. **Founding Educators.** Educators enrolled in 2026–27 are named on the curriculum site as co-development partners with standing voice in the framework's evolution.

Start the conversation.

alfredo@spcc.one · economicdemocracy.co · spcc.one